PAW & FOUND



Puppy Training Checklist

& Milestone Tracker

Week-by-week training guide • Potty tracker • Command progress chart

Your roadmap to a well-mannered pup — from day one to graduation 🎓

🏠 Weeks 1–2: Settling In

🐾 FOUNDATION SKILLS

- [ ] **Name recognition** — Say name, reward when puppy looks at you. Practice 10x daily.
- [ ] **Potty training basics** — Take out every 1–2 hours, after meals, after naps. Reward immediately after going outside.
- [ ] **Crate introduction** — Make it cozy. Feed meals inside. Never use as punishment. Start with 5–10 min sessions.
- [ ] **Handling desensitization** — Gently touch paws, ears, mouth daily. Pair with treats. Makes vet visits easier.
- [ ] **House rules established** — Where puppy sleeps, which rooms are off-limits, consistent family commands.
- [ ] **First vet visit scheduled** — Health check, vaccination plan, microchip discussion.

📝 NOTES

What's working, challenges, questions for the vet, cute moments...

🎓 Weeks 3–4: Basic Commands

🐾 CORE COMMANDS

- [ ] **Sit** — Hold treat above nose, move back over head. Puppy sits naturally. Say "Sit" → treat. Practice 10–15x daily.
- [ ] **Stay** — Start with 2 seconds, 1 step back. Gradually increase distance and duration. Use a release word like "Okay!"
- [ ] **Come (Recall)** — Happy voice, treat, and praise. Never call your puppy to punish them — "Come" must always be positive.
- [ ] **Crate training progress** — Puppy can stay quietly in crate for 30+ min. Never let puppy "cry it out" for more than 10–15 min.
- [ ] **Bite inhibition** — If puppy bites too hard during play, yelp "OW!" and stop playing for 30 seconds. Resume gently.
- [ ] **Leash introduction indoors** — Let puppy drag a light leash inside. Reward calm behavior. No pulling practice yet.

📝 NOTES

Progress notes, breakthroughs, stubborn commands, training class notes...

🌍 Weeks 5–8: Socialization & Leash

🐾 LEASH WALKING

- [ ] **Loose-leash walking** — Stop when puppy pulls. Reward when leash is loose. Short sessions (5–10 min), lots of praise.
- [ ] **"Leave it"** — Hold treat in closed fist. Puppy sniffs, eventually gives up → "Leave it" → reward from other hand.
- [ ] **"Drop it"** — Trade a toy for a treat. Never chase or pry open mouth — make dropping fun and rewarding.

🌍 SOCIALIZATION CHECKLIST

- [ ] **Met 5+ friendly vaccinated dogs** (controlled, positive interactions only)
- [ ] **Met 10+ new people** — different ages, hats, uniforms, umbrellas, sunglasses
- [ ] **Visited 3+ new places** — pet store, friend's house, outdoor café patio
- [ ] **Experienced common sounds** — vacuum, doorbell, traffic, kids playing, thunder (recordings)
- [ ] **Walked on different surfaces** — grass, concrete, gravel, carpet, metal grate
- [ ] **Comfortable with handling** — nail clippers near paws, ear cleaning, toothbrush near mouth

🚀 Weeks 9–12: Advanced Skills

🐾 ADVANCED COMMANDS

- [ ] **"Wait" at doors** — Puppy sits and waits before going through any door. Prevents door-dashing.
- [ ] **"Place" / "Go to mat"** — Send puppy to a designated bed or mat. Useful during meals or when guests arrive.
- [ ] **Impulse control** — Wait for food bowl (set down, puppy waits for "Okay!"), stay while treats are tossed nearby.
- [ ] **Polite greetings** — All four paws on floor when greeting people. Turn away and ignore jumping. Reward sitting.
- [ ] **Recall with distractions** — Come when called even with other dogs/people nearby (use long line for safety).
- [ ] **Quiet command** — Teach "speak" first (bark on cue), then "quiet" (stop barking). Useful for alert barkers!

📝 TRAINING NOTES

Training class details, trainer contact, breakthrough moments...

🚽 Potty Training Tracker

Mark: 🟢 = Went outside | 🔴 = Accident inside | 💤 = Sleeping (no accident expected)

TIME	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
6 AM							
8 AM							
10 AM							
12 PM							
2 PM							
4 PM							
6 PM							
8 PM							
10 PM							

🟢 Successes this week: ___ 🔴 Accidents this week: ___ 🎯 Goal: 0 accidents!

🚽 Potty Training Tracker (Week 2)

Mark: 🟢 = Went outside | 🔴 = Accident inside | 💤 = Sleeping

TIME	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
6 AM							
8 AM							
10 AM							
12 PM							
2 PM							
4 PM							
6 PM							
8 PM							
10 PM							

📊 Command Progress Chart

COMMAND	STARTED	GETTING IT	RELIABLE	MASTERED	NOTES
Name Recognition					
Sit					
Stay					
Come					
Down / Lie Down					
Leave It					
Drop It					
Loose Leash Walking					
Wait at Door					
Go to Place/Mat					
Polite Greetings					
Quiet					
Crate Trained					

💉 Vaccination & Vet Visit Log

VACCINE	1ST DOSE	2ND DOSE	3RD DOSE	BOOSTER DUE
DHPP (Distemper)				
Rabies				
Bordetella				
Leptospirosis				
Lyme				
Canine Influenza				

🩺 VET VISITS

DATE	WEIGHT	REASON	VET NOTES	NEXT VISIT

🛒 Puppy Supply Shopping List

- [ ] Crate (appropriately sized)
- [ ] Food & water bowls (stainless steel)
- [ ] Collar with ID tag
- [ ] Harness (front-clip recommended)
- [ ] Puppy pads (if needed)
- [ ] Chew toys (variety of textures)
- [ ] Training treats (small, soft)
- [ ] Puppy shampoo
- [ ] Travel carrier / car restraint
- [ ] Bed / mat
- [ ] Puppy food (breed-appropriate)
- [ ] Leash (6 ft, non-retractable for training)
- [ ] Poop bags + dispenser
- [ ] Enzymatic cleaner (for accidents)
- [ ] Puzzle toys / Kong
- [ ] Grooming brush + nail clippers
- [ ] Baby gate(s)
- [ ] Pet insurance (research early!)

📝 Training Notes & Memories

Favorite moments, funny stories, training breakthroughs, questions for the vet or trainer, puppy class notes, milestones reached...

🐾 Every well-trained dog started as a clumsy puppy.
You've got this!